somatic cell taken from an adult animal without the process of fertilization **(Fig. 10.8).**

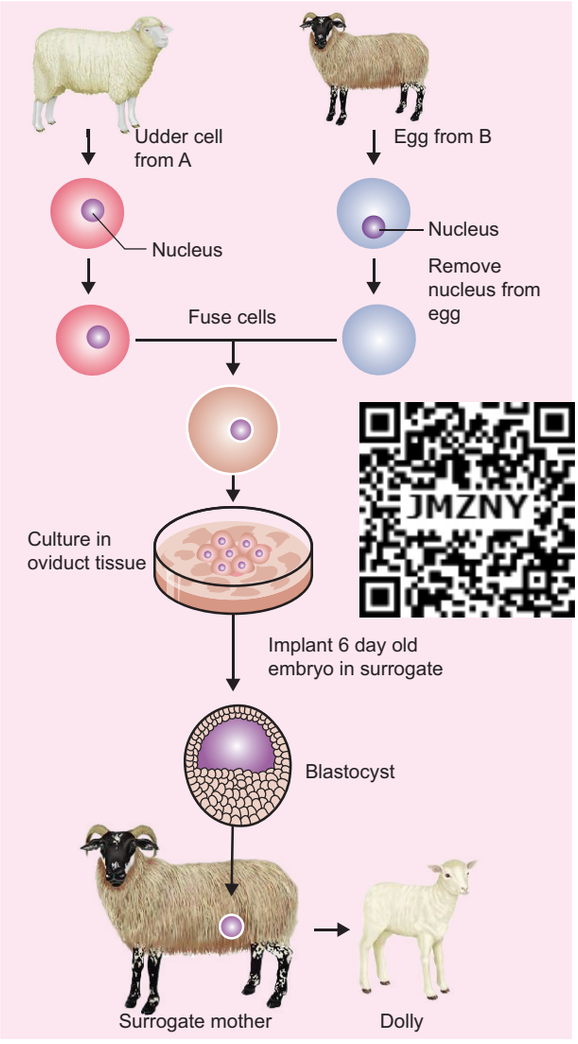


Fig. 10. 8 Cloning of dolly

Advantages and Disadvantages Of Cloning Animals

Advantages

- Offers benefits for clinical trials and medical research. It can help in the production of proteins and drugs in the field of medicine.
- Aids stem cell research.
- Animal cloning could help to save endangered species.

Disadvantages

- Animal and human activists see it as a threat to biodiversity saying that this alters evolution which will have an impact on populations and the ecosystem.
- The process is tedious and very expensive.
- It can cause animals to suffer.
- Reports show that animal surrogates were manifesting adverse outcomes and cloned animals were affected with disease and have high mortality rate.
- It might compromise human health through consumption of cloned animal meat.
- Cloned animals age faster than normal animals and are less healthy than the parent organism as discovered in Dolly.
- Cloning can lead to occurrence of genetic disorders in animals.
- More than 90% of cloning attempts fail to produce a viable offspring.



Ian Wilmut and Campbell removed 277 cells from the udder of an adult sheep and fused those cells with 277 unfertilised egg cells from which the nuclear material was removed. After culturing the resulting embryos for 6 days, they implanted 29 embryos into the surrogate mother's womb and only one Dolly was produced.

A gene 'knock out' is a genetically engineered organism that carries one or more genes in its chromosomes that have been made inoperative.

10.8 Ethical Issues

Biotechnology has given to the society cheap drugs, better friuts and vegetables, pest resistant crops, indigenious cure to diseases and lot of controversy. This is mainly because the major part of the modern biotechnology deals with genetic manipulations. People fear that these genetic manipulations may lead to unknown consequences. The major apprehension of recombinant DNA technology is that unique microorganisms either inadvertently

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